# PA 325: Introduction to Social Policy

The University of Texas at Austin
Lyndon B. Johnson School of Public Affairs
Fall 2026
Class Time: Mondays and Wednesday, 10:30 am – 12:00 pm
Classroom: SRH 3.124

**Course Instructor:** **Kellen A. Kane, Ph.D., MPA (he/him/his)**,
Assistant Professor of Instruction
Director of Undergraduate Student Success and Enrichment

## Syllabus Quick Links

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**What is PA 325: Introduction to Social Policy?**

Social policy refers to the domain of public policies aimed at enhancing the well-being and socioeconomic status of individuals through the direct and indirect provision of programs. In this course, students will examine through an interdisciplinary lens the historical and contemporary social welfare policies that affect low-income individuals in the United States.

Throughout the term, students will discuss historical trends and periods of poverty in the United States, explore theoretical frameworks that may explain the design of social welfare policies, and gain knowledge of various substantive areas comprising the social safety net in the United States. This course meets three lecture hours a week for one semester and is offered on a letter-grade basis only. There are no prerequisites for this course.

**What will I learn in PA 325: Introduction to Social Policy?**

- What are the rationales for social policies?
- What political institutions are involved in social policymaking in the United States?
- How has poverty been measured throughout the history of the United States?
- How do socio-demographic, political, economic, or attitudinal factors enable or prohibit individuals from accessing social policies in the United States?
- What are the major programs comprising the social safety net in the United States?
- How does social policy relate to other domains of public policy?

**What are the required materials?**

Instead of assigning a course text that guides our lectures, I assign a mix of academic articles, book chapters, news reports, podcasts, and engaging video clips to aid my course instruction. All assigned readings for our lectures will be made available on our course Canvas page. Links to podcasts and video clips will be provided in the syllabus. If you are unable to access a link through the syllabus, please attempt to search for it via Google, then contact a classmate, and then contact me.

In this class, you will complete an applied book report assignment. You will need to acquire a copy of ***only one of the following books.*** Select copies of these books are available for loan through the UT Library*, with some offering electronic copies available to UT students. Additionally, new and used copies of these books are available for purchase online at a relatively low cost. ***If accessing one of these books proves difficult, please come and talk to me*** after class or during my office hours.

1. Michener, Jamila. *Fragmented democracy: Medicaid, federalism, and unequal politics*. Cambridge University Press, 2018.
2. Abraham, Laurie Kaye. *Mama might be better off dead: The failure of health care in urban America*. University of Chicago Press, 2019.
3. Campbell, Andrea Louise. *Trapped in America's Safety Net: One Family's Struggle*. University of Chicago Press, 2014.

*Note: if checking the UT Library, be sure to find the *actual* copy of the book. Most of these books also have book reviews available, much like an academic research article. In the library search results, they will be listed as either "Article" or "Review".

**How will I learn?**

***Teaching Modality.*** This course is synchronous and in-person. To accommodate scheduling potential guest speakers or lectures, I reserve the right to designate specific class meetings as virtual. Any potential virtual meeting will be announced well in advance to provide students ample opportunity to secure proper space and equipment to join the class virtually.

***Communication.*** The course Canvas site can be found by navigating to the course page via your Canvas Dashboard. **Please email me through Canvas**. You are responsible for ensuring that the primary email address you have recorded with the university is the one you will check for course communications, as that is the email address Canvas uses.

***Asking for Help.*** Your success in this class is important to me. If any aspect of this course prevents you from learning or excludes you, please let me know as soon as possible. Together, we can develop strategies to meet both your needs and the course expectations. I will have weekly office hours to allow students to seek help on individual assignments, general guidance, or other areas of support. You do not need a class-related reason to meet with me. I am happy to connect with you on any topic!

***Required Devices.*** There will be various days throughout the term when students will be required to have access to a laptop or tablet to complete in-class assignments, such as exams and synchronous activities. These days when electronics will be required will be designated on the Course Calendar.

## What are the assignments in this course?

| Grade Component | Course Points | Due Date |
|---|---|---|
| Case Study Leadership | 10% | |
| Attendance and Participation | 10% | |
| Social Policy in the News | 15%, total | Wednesday, September 9, 2026<br>Wednesday, October 28, 2026 |
| Applied Book Report | 20% | Short Summary: Monday, October 5, 2026<br><br>Full Book Report: Monday, October 12, 2026 |
| *Group Advocacy Brief* | | |
| Written Policy Brief | 15% | Wednesday, November 18, 2026 |
| Group Presentation | 10% | Wednesday, December 2, 2026; OR<br>Monday, December 7, 2026 |
| Final Exam | 20% | Friday, December 11, 2026;<br>Scheduled in accordance with the University's Final Exam Schedule |

Detailed assignment instructions will be available on the course Canvas page well in advance of the assignment due date. Brief assignment descriptions for all major assignments are included at the end of the syllabus.

## How will grades be assigned?

Typically, you will be provided a numerical grade upon receiving feedback. Numerical grades will be translated to letter grades using the rubric below:

| Grade | Overall Percentage Range |
|---|---|
| A | 94% - 100% |
| A- | 90% - 93% |
| B+ | 87% - 89% |
| B | 84% - 86% |
| B- | 80% - 83% |
| C+ | 77% - 79% |
| C | 74% - 76% |
| C- | 70% - 73% |

| Grade | Overall Percentage Range |
|---|---|
| D+ | 67% - 69% |
| D | 64% - 66% |
| D- | 60% - 63% |
| F | <60% |

Note: Lower grades can be earned. I round up grades, so you need to earn a 93.45 to get an A. I rarely round up more than this.

## Course Calendar

| Class # | Date | Topic | Readings | Assignment Due |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Monday,<br>August 24, 2026 | Course overview; assignments overview; student expectations | • Syllabus and Assignment Descriptions | |
| 2 | Wednesday,<br>August 26, 2026 | Defining social policy guiding theoretical frameworks | • Herrick, John M. (rev. Johnson, David H. and DiNitto, Diana, M.). 2021. "Social Welfare Policy: Overview". Encyclopedia of Social Work. 10/29/21.<br>• Phelan, Sean and Dawes, Simon. 2018. "Liberalism and Neoliberalism". Oxford Research Encyclopedias. 2/26/18. | |
| 3 | Monday,<br>August 31, 2026 | Major US political institutions shaping social policy | • Bryner, Gary. 2006. "Welfare Policy". Center for the Study of Federalism.<br>• Ford, Leslie. 2021. "Safety-Net Reform: How State Policymakers Can Lead". The Heritage Foundation.<br>• ***SKIM**:* Lasky, Jack. 2025. "Constitutional challenges to the Affordable Care Act". ESCBO. | |
| 4 | Wednesday,<br>September 2, 2026 | Defining and measuring poverty | • Burkhauser, Richard V. et al. "Addressing the Shortcoming of the Supplemental Poverty Measure". 2021. American Enterprise Institute.<br>• Meyer, Daneil R. and Wallace, Geoffrey L. 2009. "Chapter 2: Poverty Levels and Trends in Comparative Perspective" (in "Changing Poverty, Changing Policies". Cancian, Maria and Danziger, Sheldon, eds.) | |
| | Monday,<br>September 7, 2026 | No class; Labor Day | | |
| 5 | Wednesday,<br>September 9, 2026 | Inequality in the safety net and the effects of poverty | • Simon, Dan. "Poverty Fact Sheet: Poor and In Poor Health". Institute for Research on Poverty.<br>• Kelly, Paige. 2025. "The Local Welfare State and Differences in Racialized Poverty". The Sociological Quarterly.<br>• ***SKIM**:* Ferguson, HB, Bovaird, S, and Mueller, MP. 2007. "The impact of poverty on educational outcomes on children". 10/2007.<br>• ***SKIM**:* Ochieng, Nacy, Cubanski, Juliette, Neuman, Tricia, and Damico, Anthony. 2024. "How Many Older Adults Live in Poverty?". 5/21/24. | Social Policy in the News 1 |

| Class # | Date | Topic | Readings | Assignment Due |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6 | Monday, September 14, 2026 | Social constructions of target populations | • Schneider, Anne and Ingram, Helen. 1993. "Social Construction of Target Populations: Implications for Politics and Policy". The American Political Science Review. 6/1993.<br>• ***SKIM**:* Kreitzer, Rebecca J. and Smith, Candis Watts. 2018. "Reproducible and replicable: An empirical assessment of the social construction of politically relevant target groups". PS: Political Science & Politics. 10/2018 | |
| 7 | Wednesday, September 16, 2026 | Social stratification | • Yglesias, Matthew. 2015. "Stop using income as a guide to economic class". Vox. 5/12/2015.<br>• Marcuse, Peter. 2014. "Poverty or Inequality: What's the Problem". Peter Marcuse's Blog. 1/26/14 | |
| 8 | Monday, September 21, 2026 | Historical context and trends in US anti-poverty policy: Poor Law and Settlement Houses | • ***SKIM**:* Katz, Michael B. 1996. "In the Shadow of the Poorhouse". Chapter 1 and Chapter 2 | |
| 9 | Wednesday, September 23, 2026 | Historical context and trends in US anti-poverty policy: The New Deal and LBJ's War on Poverty | • ***SKIM**:* Patterson, James T. 2000. "America's Struggle against Poverty in the Twentieth Century". Chapter 3 and Chapter 4 | |
| 10 | Monday, September 28, 2026 | The design of the current social safety net and the submerged state | • Winship, Scott. "The Conservative Case Against Child Allowances". 2021. American Enterprise Institute.<br>• Rector, Robert. "Understanding Marriage Penalties in Welfare and Their Impact on Society". 2025. The Heritage Foundation.<br>• Mettler, Suzanne. "Why Americans Can't See Government -- and Why It Matters". 2011. Scholars Strategy Network. | |
| 11 | Wednesday, September 30, 2026 | Administrative burdens in social policy | • Rosalsky, Greg. 2025. "The paperwork trap: A sneaky way to cut Medicaid in the 'One Big Beautiful Bill'?". NPR. 6/26/2025<br>• Leiserson, Greg. 2025. "The GOP plan to cut the EITC via administrative burdens". Can We Still Govern? 5/19/2025 | |

| Class # | Date | Topic | Readings | Assignment Due |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 12 | Monday,<br>October 5, 2026 | Geography and the social safety net | • Kneebone, Elizabeth. 2017. "The changing geography of US poverty". The Brookings Institute. 2/15/17.<br>• Watson, Tara and Goodman, Gabriela. 2024. “The social safety net looks different in every state”. The Brookings Institution. 6/4/2024. | Post short book summary on Canvas Discussion Board |
| 13 | Wednesday,<br>October 7, 2026 | Evaluating social policies | • Greve, Bent. 2017. "Chapter 1: Introduction: Evaluation as an instrument in social policy". (in "Handbook of Social Policy Evaluation". Greve, Brent, ed.) | |
| 14 | Monday,<br>October 12, 2026 | Movie Screening: Work & Happiness: The Human Cost of Welfare | | Applied Book Report |
| 15 | Wednesday,<br>October 14, 2026 | Book and Movie discussion | • Read the book summaries posted by your classmates on Canvas! | |
| 16 | Monday,<br>October 19, 2026 | Health: Insurance-based programs | • Swartz, Katherine. 2009. "Chapter 12: Health Care for the Poor: For Whom, What Care, and Whose Responsibility" (in "Changing Poverty, Changing Policies". Cancian, Maria and Danziger, Sheldon, eds.) | |
| 17 | Wednesday,<br>October 21, 2026 | Health: Non-insurance-based programs | • Kreitzer, Rebecca J., Smith, Candis Watts, Kane, Kellen A., and Saunders, Tracee. 2021. "Affordable but inaccessible? Contraception deserts in the US states". Journal of Health Policy, Policy and Law.<br>• Ryan White HIV/AIDS Program. 2024. "Program Parts and Initiatives". Health Resources & Services Administration. 12/2024. | |
| 18 | Monday,<br>October 26, 2026 | Nutrition: SNAP and WIC | • Gundersen, Craig and Ziliak, James P. 2015. "Food Insecurity and Health Outcomes". Health Affairs. 11/2015<br>• Mercier, Stephanie. 2012. "Review of U.S. Nutrition Assistance Policy: Programs and Issues". AGree. 6/2012. Read Executive Summary and Pages 1-19 | |

| Class # | Date | Topic | Readings | Assignment Due |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 19 | Wednesday, October 28, 2026 | Nutrition: Community- and school-based programs | • The Associated Press. 2023. "A new study offers hints that healthier school lunches may help reduce obesity". NPR. 2/15/23.<br>• Toosi, Saied. 2024. "State Universal Free School Meal Policies Reduced Food Insufficiency Among Children in the 2022-2023 School Year". U.S. Department of Agriculture. 6/13/24.<br>• ***SKIM**:* Sheffield, Rachel and Bakst, Darren. 2017. "Welfare for the Wealthy? Congress Should Immediately Stop Pushing Universal Free School Meals". The Heritage Foundation. | Social Policy in the News 2 |
| 20 | Monday, November 2, 2026 | Labor and employment: Wage-based policies and tax programs | • Romich, J.L., Simmelink, J., & Holt, S.D. (2007). "When Working Harder Does Not Pay: Low-income Working Families, Tax Liabilities, and Benefit Reductions." Families in Society, 88(3): 418-426.<br>• ***SKIM**:* Winship, Scott. "Reforming Tax Credits to Promote Child Opportunity and Aid Working Families. 2021. American Enterprise Institute.<br>• ***SKIM**:* Congressional Budget Office (2014). "The Effects of a Minimum-Wage Increase on Employment and Family Income." | |
| | Wednesday, November 4, 2026 | Group project meetings | • Use class time to meet with your group; no formal class meeting -- Dr. Kane at the Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference. | |
| 21 | Monday, November 9, 2026 | Education: Early childhood educational programs | • Duncan, G., Ludwig, J., & Magnuson, K.S. (2007). "Reducing poverty through preschool interventions." Future of Children, 17(2): 143–60<br>• Cilesiz, Sebnem and Drotos, Stephanie M. 2016. "High-Poverty Urban High School Students' Plans for Higher Education: Weaving Their Own Safety Nets". Urban Education. | |
| 22 | Wednesday, November 11, 2026 | Education: Postsecondary educational programs | • Bell, Elizabeth (2021). "Does Free Community College Improve Student Outcomes? Evidence from a Regression Discontinuity Design". Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis. 2/17/21<br>• Nichols, Andrew Howard. 2015. "The Pell Partnership: Ensuring a Shared Responsibility for Low-Income Student Success". The Education Trust. 9/2015. | |

| Class # | Date | Topic | Readings | Assignment Due |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 23 | Monday,<br>November 16, 2026 | Housing: Demand-side housing policy | • Center on Budget and Policy Priorities. 2026. "Project-Based Vouchers". Policy Basics. Updated 6/11/26.<br>• [Video] Rothstein, Richard. 2019. "The Color of Law". Brown University Center for the Study of Race and Ethnicity in America. 2/12/19. Watch the video<br>• Aliprantis, Dionissi, Martin, Hal, and Phillips, David. 2022. "Landlords and Access to Opportunity". Journal of Urban Economics, 129: 103420. ***Read the Abstract and Introduction.*** *Skim the rest of the paper if you would like.* | |
| 24 | Wednesday,<br>November 18, 2026 | Housing: Supply-side housing policy | • Bisaha, Stephan. 2026. "Largest Housing Affordability Bill in Decades Becomes Law Without Trump's Signature". NPR. 7/11/26.<br>• Su, Yipeng, Freemark, Yonah, and Curran-Groome, Will. 2026. "How Upzoning Affects Housing Supply: Evidence and Implications for Designing Zoning Reform That Works". Urban Institute, Housing Matters. 6/1/26.<br>• Tax Policy Center. 2024. "What Is the Low-Income Housing Tax Credit and How Does It Work?". Tax Policy Center Briefing Book. Updated 1/2024. | Group Advocacy Brief: Written Policy Brief |
| | Monday,<br>November 23, 2026 | No class; Fall break | | |
| | Wednesday,<br>November 25, 2026 | No class; Fall break | | |
| 25 | Monday,<br>November 30, 2026 | Course reflection/flex day/presentation prep | | |
| 26 | Wednesday,<br>December 2, 2026 | Group presentations | | Group Advocacy Brief: Group Presentations |
| 27 | Monday,<br>December 7, 2026 | Group presentations | | Group Advocacy Brief: Group Presentations |
| | Friday,<br>December 11, 2026 | FINAL EXAM | | Final Exam |

**Additional Policies and Items to Note:**

***Sharing of Course Material.*** No materials used in this class, including, but not limited to, lecture hand-outs, videos, assessments (quizzes, exams, papers, projects, homework assignments), in-class materials, review sheets, and additional problem sets, may be shared online or with anyone outside of the class without explicit, written permission of the instructor. Unauthorized sharing of materials promotes cheating. The University is aware of the sites used for sharing materials, and any materials found online that are associated with you, or any suspected unauthorized sharing of materials, will be reported to Student Conduct and Academic Integrity in the Office of the Dean of Students. These reports can result in initiation of the student conduct process and include charge(s) for academic misconduct, potentially resulting in sanctions, including a grade impact.

***Content warning.*** Our classroom provides an open space for the critical and orderly exchange of ideas through discussion. Some readings and other content in this course will include topics and comments that some students may find offensive and/or traumatizing. I'll aim to forewarn students about potentially disturbing content, and I ask all students to help to create an atmosphere of mutual respect and sensitivity.

***Artificial Intelligence.*** There are several evolving generative AI technologies at our fingertips. These technologies can be used as tools or as weapons. I hope that students are empowered to learn how to employ them responsibly and ethically as well as to become familiar with their strengths (e.g. ideas generation, summarizing), weaknesses (e.g. garbled and often incoherent writing), biases (e.g. reproduction of stereotypes), and flaws (e.g. hallucinations, incorrect citations). Students are allowed to use advanced automated tools (artificial intelligence or machine learning tools such as ChatGPT or Dall-E 2) on assignments in this course at the prewriting (e.g. identifying references) and editing/revising stages (e.g. grammar tools, thesauri, and diction monitoring) of writing assignments in this course, if and only if, this use is properly documented and credited. **For more information on my expectations on acceptable uses of AI, please consult our Canvas page.**

***Academic Integrity Expectations.*** Students who violate University rules on academic misconduct are subject to the student conduct process. A student found responsible for academic misconduct may be assigned both a status sanction and a grade impact for the course. The grade impact could range from a zero on the assignment in question up to a failing grade in the course. A status sanction can include a written warning, probation, deferred suspension or dismissal from the University. To learn more about academic integrity standards, tips for avoiding a potential academic misconduct violation, and the overall conduct process, please visit the Student Conduct and Academic Integrity website at: http://deanofstudents.utexas.edu/conduct.

***Absences.*** Attendance is expected and crucial for student success in the course. On certain course meetings, attendance will be required to complete in-class assignments and exercises. If you face extreme circumstances that would require you to miss multiple class sessions, talk to me, and we can see what accommodations are available.

***Religious Holy Days.*** By UT Austin policy, you must notify me of your pending absence for a religious holy day as far in advance as possible of the date of observance. If you must miss a class, an examination, a work assignment, or a project in order to observe a religious holy day, you will be given an opportunity to complete the missed work within a reasonable time after the absence. For questions regarding religious accommodations, please contact the Office of the Dean of Students.

***Notice of Academic Accommodations from Disability and Access (D&A).*** The university is committed to creating an accessible and inclusive learning environment for students with disabilities consistent with university policy and federal and state law. Please let me know if you experience any barriers to learning so I can work with you to ensure you have equal opportunity to participate fully in this course. If you are a student with a disability, or think you may have a disability, and need accommodations please contact Disability and Access (D&A). Please refer to D&A's website for contact and more information: http://disability.utexas.edu/. If

you are already registered with D&A , please deliver your accommodation letter to me as early as possible in the semester so we can discuss your approved accommodations and needs in this course.

***Late Assignments:*** Assignments, exams, and quizzes are due at a specified time. I am willing to accommodate only exceptional circumstances if the student made arrangements in advance and the exceptional circumstances are *well documented*. This means that students should get in touch with me days – not hours – before the assignment is due. In fairness to everyone, you should turn in your assignments on time, as additional time is a luxury. Assignments turned in after the deadline *but within three days* of the due date may receive partial credit. Exams are unable to be turned in late.

***Re-grading:*** I will gladly take another look at assignments that students feel are not graded fairly if students approach me about it in my office hours or appointment. I will only do this over 24 hours *after* the grades are returned. The purpose of this waiting period is to give you a chance to really think about the graded item and consider your response. Students must type up a justification for why they believe the score should be different. If I feel the assignment was graded unfairly, I'll change the grade in the student's favor, but I also reserve the right to lower the grade upon reading if, after reevaluation, I think the student received too high a grade. This system is designed to minimize frivolous grade appeals and to ensure that you have carefully examined and reflected on the quality of your work before deciding to initiate a grade appeal. It is also to ensure fairness to all students by ensuring equitable grading standards across students.

***Classroom Recording Statement:*** HOP 2-9970 prohibits students from recording class instruction (audio or video) unless a student obtains the instructor's permission or Disability & Access has approved audio recording as an accommodation. For any questions regarding this, please reach out to me directly.

***Additional University Policies and Resources for Students:*** For additional information on UT Policies and Resources for Students, please see the Canvas supplement to UT syllabi.

**Important Safety Information**

Carrying of Handguns on Campus

Students in this class should be aware of the following university policies related to Texas' Open Carry Law:

- Students in this class who hold a license to carry are asked to review the university policy regarding campus carry.
- Individuals who hold a license to carry are eligible to carry a concealed handgun on campus, including in most outdoor areas, buildings and spaces that are accessible to the public, and in classrooms.
- It is the responsibility of concealed-carry license holders to carry their handguns on or about their person at all times while on campus. Open carry is NOT permitted, meaning that a license holder may not carry a partially or wholly visible handgun on campus premises or on any university driveway, street, sidewalk or walkway, parking lot, parking garage, or other parking area.

**Assignment Descriptions**

***Case Study Leadership.*** Class-wide discussions are a hallmark experience of small-section elective courses in Public Affairs. During select weeks of our course, small teams of 3-4 students will lead a portion of class discussion by identifying and presenting a real, current case related to social policy at the national, state, or local level. As case study leaders, your team will be responsible for explaining what your case is, why it matters, and how it connects to that week's (or an earlier week's) course material, and for developing discussion questions and/or activities to create space for your classmates to engage directly with the case. Each team will lead one case study discussion during the semester, lasting approximately 15 to 20 minutes.

***Social Policy in the News.*** Throughout the course, you will be asked to identify current local, state, and national current events directly related to social policy. *Current* events should be *current*. That is, you are expected to identify events that occur within a reasonable timeframe from the assignments' due dates. For each current event submission, you are expected to submit a short summary of the identified current event at the corresponding level of government, identify the policy 'problem,' link the current event to course material, and engage with how the topic may differentially affect various communities. You will complete two Social Policy in the News assignments throughout the semester, weighted equally.

***Applied Book Report.*** In this course, we discuss a variety of social policies, both historic and contemporary, that provide services or benefits to low-income individuals. In lieu of a formal midterm examination, the Applied Book Report Assignment offers an opportunity to engage with a text that provides a deeper examination of a substantive or design element of the social safety net in the United States. In the Applied Book Report, you will summarize the assigned text, provide critical commentary and draw connections to our course material, and offer your own reflection on how the book furthered your understanding of social policy.

***Group Advocacy Brief.*** In the second half of the semester, you will research and write an advocacy-oriented brief. As part of the project, you will be assigned a target population relevant to U.S. social policy. Your work will culminate in a visually engaging policy brief and a group presentation. The objective of this assignment, collectively, is to teach yourself more about how different populations experience social, political, or economic problems, think critically about potential improvements to the design of social policy, and gain practice in presenting your analysis to a variety of stakeholder audiences through both written and oral communication.

- *Written Policy Brief.* In small groups, you will put yourselves in the shoes of advocates to improve socioeconomic, health, and well-being outcomes for a specific target population. This policy brief is intended to be persuasive in nature, meaning you will make recommendations as knowledgeable policy professionals on how to improve the design of social programs. Your written brief will be 10 to 15 pages in total and should be beautiful, compelling, and comprehensive.
- *Group Presentation.* Whether you want to work in government, are passionate about advocacy or activism, or plan to pursue a career in the private sector, being able to create compelling, effective communication materials is a valuable skill. In this final stage, you will give a short presentation and then respond to questions about the project. You should assume that the audience comprises stakeholders, policymakers, and other activists. Your presentation should introduce the target population, examine their unique experiences with social policy, and conclude with your recommended policy solutions. After the presentation, there will be a few minutes for you to answer audience questions.

***Final Exam.*** Our Final Exam will be held on Friday, December 11th, from 8:00 to 10:00 a.m. CT, in accordance with university policy, which states that examinations for classes not held during a standard time block default to the closest standard class beginning time. As the sole formal exam in the course, it will be a cumulative assessment of our semester's material. The questions will go beyond simply restating the lecture slides and instead apply these concepts to reach a deeper level of thinking.